Design 221
Personal Design Practice

Nicky Ning
nnin463
379461283



My Design Identity

01 / PROJECT BACKGROUND

Through my previous tattoo design practice, I became interested in flowing lines, clean compositions and expressive details. However, I realised that although I had created several designs, I did not have a consistent visual identity to present my work. This made me want to explore how I could build a personal brand that better represents my style and interests.

02 / PROJECT AIM

My aim is to create a personal visual identity inspired by my tattoo design practice. I want to explore different typography, colours and graphic elements to find a style that feels personal, recognisable and professional. I also want this identity to work consistently across my portfolio website, CV and social media.

03 / RESEARCH QUESTION

How can I build a personal visual identity that reflects my tattoo-inspired style while remaining clear, consistent and professional?

04 / DESIGN KEYWORDS

MINIMAL — Clean compositions and controlled details.
FLOWING — Natural lines and fluid movement.
EXPRESSIVE — Personal character and creative expression.







Moodboard



01 / RESEARCH DIRECTION

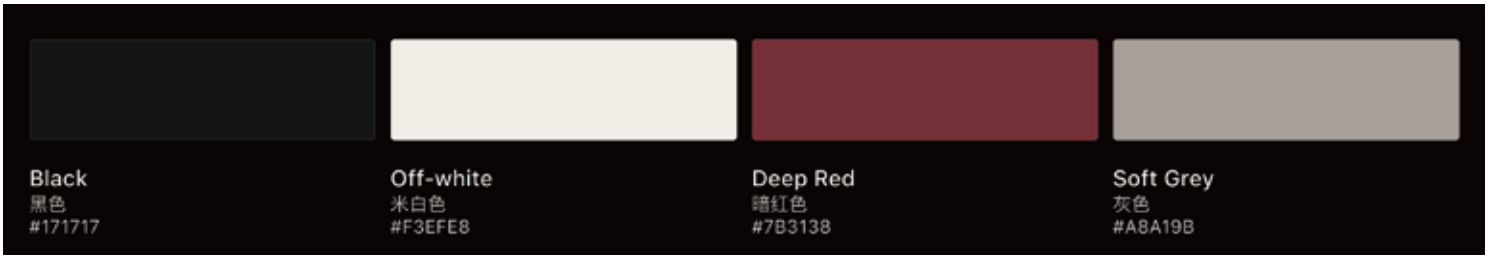
I started by looking at visual styles that could represent my interest in tattoo design. I focused on flowing linework, expressive typography and a minimal colour combination. I wanted to find a balance between an artistic tattoo-inspired style and a clean, professional identity that could work across different platforms.

02 / LINEWORK INSPIRATION

I was drawn to the movement and flexibility of fine lines. They can create an expressive visual style without making the composition too complicated.

03 / TYPOGRAPHY INSPIRATION

I explored bold and elegant typography because I wanted my personal identity to feel artistic while remaining easy to recognise and read.



04 / COLOUR & COMPOSITION

I was interested in using black and off-white as the main colours, with dark red as a possible accent. This could create contrast while keeping the overall design controlled and consistent.

05 / INITIAL COLOUR DIRECTION

Black and off-white will be the main colours to keep the identity clean and professional. Deep red will be used as an accent colour to add emotion and individuality.

Logo Exploration

01 / DESIGN DIRECTION

I was drawn to elegant serif fonts because they feel refined, artistic and expressive. The thin and thick contrast creates a strong visual character, which matches the delicate and flowing style of tattoo design.

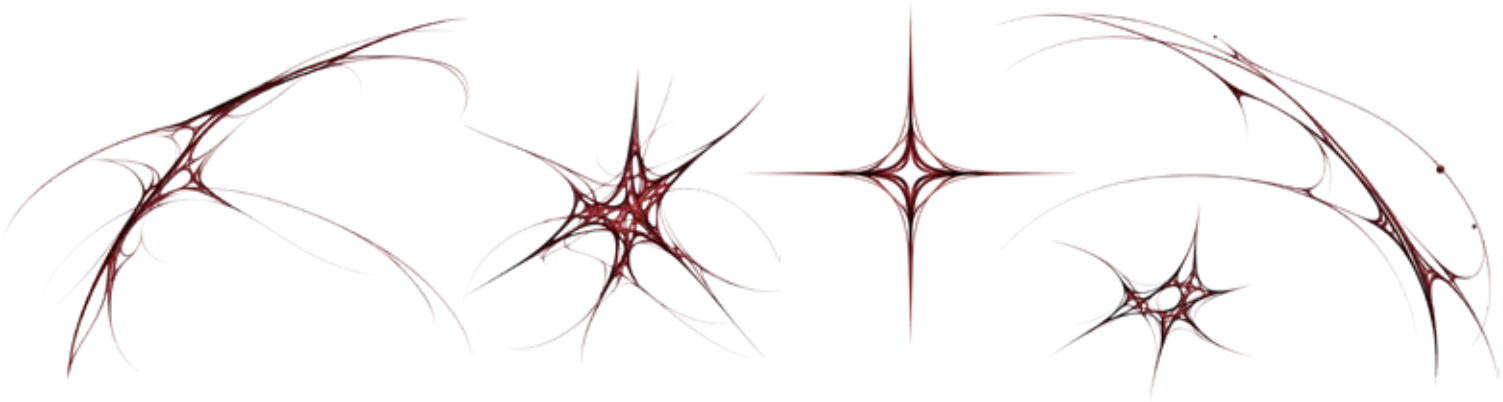
02 / ITERATION PROCESS

I started with a clean serif font and adjusted the letter proportions and spacing to create a stronger foundation for my personal wordmark. At first, the lettering looked elegant, but I felt it was still too simple and did not fully reflect my interest in tattoo design. I then experimented with adding flowing lines inspired by tattoo artwork, allowing some of the curves to extend around and connect with the letters. This made the design feel more expressive and created a stronger sense of movement. However, as I added more lines and decorative details, I noticed that some areas became too crowded and the letters were harder to recognise. To improve this, I reduced some unnecessary curves, adjusted the thickness of the lines and refined the connection points between the letters and graphic elements. I also experimented with small star-shaped details to create visual highlights without making the composition too complicated. After several adjustments, I developed a more balanced version that combines elegant typography with flowing tattoo-inspired elements while keeping the name clear and readable.

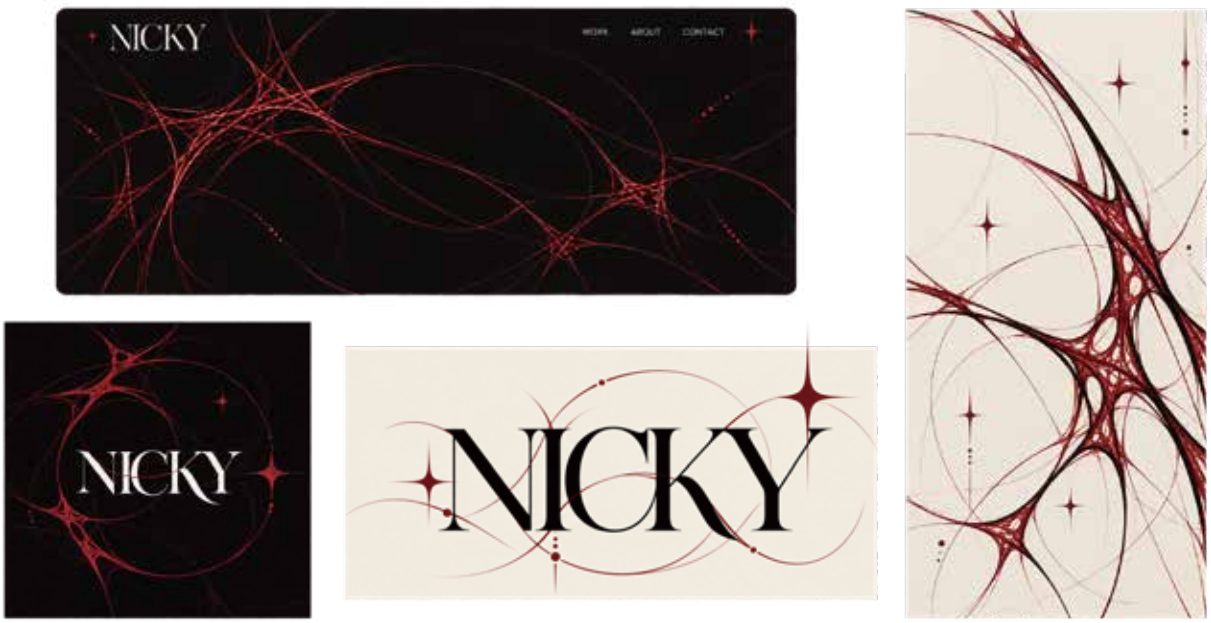


Element Exploration

For my element exploration, I wanted to develop a visual language that connects with my interest in tattoo design while keeping my personal identity clean and recognisable. I started by exploring organic curves, flowing lines and sharp connection points inspired by tattoo linework. I was particularly interested in how thin curves could create movement, while sharper shapes could add tension and visual impact. From these experiments, I developed several graphic elements, including starbursts, flowing lines, connection points, curved segments and thorn-like forms. I chose these elements because they share similar shapes and can be combined without losing their individual character.



I tested how these graphics could work alongside my NICKY wordmark and within simple compositions for social media, posters and website backgrounds. Through these explorations, I wanted to create a flexible graphic system that feels artistic and connected to tattoo design without making every application look overly complicated.



OpenAI. (2026). [AI-generated image]. OpenAI.

Brand Application

After developing my personal visual identity, I wanted to see how it would work across different platforms. I applied my typography, colour palette and graphic elements to website, mobile, business card, Instagram and contact mockups. My main focus was keeping everything consistent without making the designs too complicated. I used black, off-white and deep red to connect the different applications, while adding small flowing lines and decorative details to reflect my tattoo-inspired style.









OpenAl. (2026). [Al-generated image]. OpenAl.



Overall Reflection

Looking back at this project, I feel that the most valuable part was learning how to turn my personal interests into something that could represent me professionally. At the beginning, I had a general idea of what I liked, but I was not sure how to bring everything together into a clear personal identity. As I worked through the different experiments, I realised that making individual designs look interesting was much easier than making them work together as one complete system.

One of the biggest challenges I faced was deciding how to present myself as a designer. Although tattoo design is an important part of my creative interests, I did not want my personal identity to make people think I could only work in one specific area. At first, I focused too much on creating a strong tattoo-inspired appearance, but I gradually realised that this could limit how others understood my abilities. To solve this, I started thinking about which elements could represent my design approach rather than just tattoo art itself. I kept the artistic details that reflected my interests, but combined them with a cleaner layout and more flexible visual language. This allowed me to express my personality while leaving room for other types of design work. Through this challenge, I learned that a personal identity should not only reflect what I am interested in now, but also support how I want to develop as a designer in the future.

This process also changed how I think about my own design practice. Previously, I often focused on completing an individual artwork, but this project encouraged me to consider how people would experience and understand my work as a whole. I learned to evaluate my designs not only by how they looked, but also by whether they communicated my intentions clearly. I also became more aware of the importance of documenting my decisions, because looking back at different versions helped me understand why certain approaches worked better than others.

Although I am satisfied with the direction I have developed, I know that creating a personal identity is not something that finishes with one project. My next step is to develop my portfolio website further, introduce more of my original work and collect feedback on how others understand my design identity. I also want to build a habit of regularly reviewing and updating my portfolio as my skills improve. This experience helped me realise that growing as a designer is not only about producing more work, but also about learning how to present it, reflect on it and continue improving over time.

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